## How to use this checklist

This sheet is the week-by-week “did we do it” companion for the data workstream of your HCM implementation. A migration checklist is not a task list — it is a lifecycle discipline: every phase has entry criteria, a named owner, and a gate signed before the next phase begins. Work each phase top to bottom, tick every box, fill in Owner, Wave/Load, and Date as you go, and do not start the next phase until the current gate is signed. Keep the mock-load tracker and freeze plan sheets live until cutover.

*Contents: seven gated phase checklists · mock-load cycle tracker · data freeze plan sheet · common-mistakes guardrail*

## 1 Scoping, Sources & Ownership

- [ ] Scope written in three sentences: what migrates, what stays behind, how much history comes along.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Scope signed by payroll and HR leadership.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Every source system inventoried with name, owner, and extract format.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Shadow sources identified: the spreadsheets local offices have maintained for years.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Named owner set per data object; migration lead, payroll lead, HR data owner, and PM roles assigned.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Retention rules defined; where applicable, documented where employee personal data is extracted, staged, and loaded across the Canada–US border.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*

## 2 Extraction: Freeze Windows & Delta Capture

- [ ] Freeze window negotiated with payroll operations around the processing calendar.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Delta-capture method chosen and designed before extraction; every change between final extraction and cutover is captured.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Extracts built as repeatable scripts — not one-off exports.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Extraction schedule set.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*

## 3 Cleansing: Fix the Data Before It Travels

- [ ] De-duplication completed, including rehire records entered as two records.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Standardization to target code lists: free-text entries converted; pay-code mapping begun with the payroll lead.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Missing required fields completed at the source; documented defaults used only where the business approved them.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Cleansing completed BEFORE transformation — never after.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*

## 4 Transformation & Mapping

- [ ] Field maps documented and signed off: source field, target field, logic, approving owner.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Pay-code mapping validated and SIGNED by the payroll lead — not merely reviewed.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Unmapped codes routed to an explicit exception queue; none dropped silently.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] ID strategy decided once and applied everywhere: rehires, multi-system records, cross-border transfers.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Mapping document is a controlled artifact after the first mock load.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*

## 5 Test Loads: Mock Loads & the Dress Rehearsal

- [ ] Mock loads run early against the current mapping — their job is to break.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Full reconciliation battery run on EVERY load, including mock loads.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Dress rehearsal run on the real timeline with the same people, scripts, and gate discipline.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Fixes made in transformation with a full reload — never hand-edits to target data.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*

## 6 Reconciliation: The Gate Every Load Passes Through

- [ ] Record counts reconciled by category.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Gross-to-net totals reconciled by pay group.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Deduction and accrual totals reconciled by code.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Hash totals verified at extraction, staging, and target.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Tolerance bands defined BEFORE the first load.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Sampled detail verification across groups, statuses, locations, and both sides of the border.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Country-by-country reconciliation where cross-border — no blended totals.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Per-load written sign-off obtained.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*

## 7 Cutover Sign-Off

- [ ] Sign-off pack assembled: reconciliation results for every load.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Variance log complete with every item triaged to a root cause.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Defects closed; user acceptance results included.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Rollback plan written and approved.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Hypercare roster set.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] Payroll lead signed the payroll verdict; HR data owner signed the HR-side totals.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*
- [ ] PM owns the gate; sign-off is per load and per gate, in writing.
  *Owner _____ Wave/Load _____ Date _____*

## Mock-Load Cycle Tracker

*One row per load. No load is accepted without the full reconciliation battery and a written sign-off.*

| Load # | Date | Records in | Records out | Variances | Pass criteria met (Y/N) | Sign-off |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | |
| | | | | | | |
| | | | | | | |
| | | | | | | |

## Data Freeze Plan Sheet

**Freeze start:** date & time — when source data locks or the allowed-change log begins

_____

**Freeze end:** date & time — cutover point

_____

**Read-only enforcement method:** e.g. role lock, system freeze, monitored allowed-change list

_____

**Delta-capture log (who / what / when):** every change between final extraction and cutover, logged and reconciled after the main load

_____

## Common-Mistakes Guardrail

*Run this list before every gate. Every unchecked row is a risk accepted — in writing.*

- ☐ ✗ Verified we did NOT do this: Extracting before scope is written — every stakeholder assumed their data was included.
- ☐ ✗ Verified we did NOT do this: Missing the shadow sources — the spreadsheets surface after the mapping is done.
- ☐ ✗ Verified we did NOT do this: No delta strategy — the business keeps running; stale data goes live.
- ☐ ✗ Verified we did NOT do this: Cleansing after transformation — dirty data fails reconciliation three loads later.
- ☐ ✗ Verified we did NOT do this: Unmapped codes dropping silently — every unmapped code belongs in an exception queue.
- ☐ ✗ Verified we did NOT do this: Reconciling only the final load — mock loads without reconciliation teach nothing.
- ☐ ✗ Verified we did NOT do this: Blending cross-border totals — figures nobody can validate.
- ☐ ✗ Verified we did NOT do this: Cutover without a rollback plan — if you cannot describe failure, you are not ready.